Northwind Trading - Employee Handbook (fictional sample for evaluation)

1. Scope
This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Northwind Trading. Independent contractors and agency workers are governed by their own contracts and are not covered by this handbook.

Questions about this handbook should be sent to the People Team.

2. Working Hours and Remote Work

Standard working hours are 9:00 to 17:30, Monday to Friday, which is 37.5 hours per week including a 30-minute unpaid lunch break.

Employees may work remotely for up to 2 days per week once they have completed their probation period, with their manager's approval.

Remote work is not available to warehouse staff, because their duties require them to be on site.

3. Annual Leave and Sick Leave

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays. Part-time employees receive annual leave pro rata to their contracted hours.

Up to 5 unused days of annual leave may be carried forward to the next year. Carried-forward days must be used by 31 March; any carried-forward days not used by then are lost.

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. A medical certificate is required for any sickness absence longer than 3 consecutive days.

4. Parental Leave

Maternity leave is 26 weeks. The first 16 weeks are paid at full salary and the remaining 10 weeks are unpaid.

Paternity leave is 2 weeks at full salary. It must be taken within 8 weeks of the child's birth.

To be eligible for paid maternity or paternity leave, an employee must have at least 6 months of continuous service on the expected date of birth.

5. Travel and Expenses

Expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of the expense, together with the original receipts. Claims above 250 EUR require approval from the head of department.

Flights must be booked in economy class. Premium economy is allowed for flights longer than 6 hours.

Hotel costs are reimbursed up to 150 EUR per night, or up to 200 EUR per night in London and Paris. Alcohol is never reimbursed.

6. Probation, Resignation and Leaving

The probation period is 6 months. During probation, either side may end employment with 1 week of notice.

After probation, employees who resign must give 1 month of written notice during their first year of service, and 2 months of written notice after their first year. Notice must be given in writing to both the manager and the People Team.

The company may choose to pay salary instead of notice. Any unused annual leave, including carried-forward days, is paid out in the final salary.